

HSU, Ke-Cheng (Clio)

許可證

(852) 6840 9753 | khsu@connect.ust.hk | <https://cliohsu1997.github.io> | github.com/cliohsu1997

BUSINESS ADDRESS

Department of Economics, Lee Shau Kee Business Building
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Clear Water Bay, Kowloon, Hong Kong

DESIRED RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS

Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics, Empirical Industrial Organization

EDUCATION

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Ph.D. in Economics

2020 – 2027 (expected)

Research interests: Industrial Organization and Applied Microtheory.

Master of Philosophy in Economics

2020 – 2022

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Economics

2015 – 2019

Minor in Actuarial Mathematics

WORKING PAPERS

- “Designing Return Policy in E-Commerce: The Role of Excess Return and Surplus Extraction” (*Job Market Paper*)

Abstract: Return policy design is central to social welfare, yet its welfare effects are ambiguous when policies jointly shape purchases, prices, and return behavior. Policy effects operate through both return discipline and market participation, and the two margins can pull in opposite directions. We estimate a structural model of purchase and return decisions using Taobao transaction data under RRSI and CRSI, and evaluate return-penalty discount (RPD) alternatives. Return policy should be tailored to category margins and return-handling costs rather than imposed uniformly.

Presentations: HKUST Business School PhD Conference; CEP Brownbag, HKUST; 中国经济学年会夏季论坛 * (* scheduled)

- “Product Design with Heterogeneous Search Costs” (*MPhil thesis*), with AU Pak Hung

Abstract: Building on Wolinsky’s (1986) sequential search model with differentiated products, this paper introduces search cost heterogeneity to analyze how firms leverage observable product designs to influence consumer search behavior. In equilibrium, low-search-cost consumers tend to seek niche products, while higher-search-cost consumers gravitate toward standardized products. Prices may respond asymmetrically to reductions in search costs depending on where the shock occurs in the search-cost distribution.

Presentations: APIOC 2023; AMES 2023, NTU Singapore

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Too Much Unsold Stock?: Environmental Consequences of Price Commitment”, with Kohei Kawaguchi and Kei Kawai

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research

Research Assistant for Prof. Benjamin Bernard, National Taiwan University

2020

Teaching

Lecturer, Math Camp for MSc in Economics, HKUST	2026
Teaching Assistant Coordinator, Business School, HKUST	2025 – 2026
Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, HKUST	2020 – 2025

Courses: Macroeconomics; Industrial Organization & Competitive Strategy; Economics of Uncertainty and Information; Microeconomic Theory I; Microeconomic Theory II

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Postgraduate Studentship from the HKUST, 2020 – present
Red Bird PhD Award, 2022
Academic Achievement Medal, 2019
University Scholarship (730K HKD), 2015 – 2019

REFERENCES

Available upon request.